



Elena Zhakov  
Clark University

March 28, 2025

Dear Elena:

In 2007 Shirley Riopel-Nelson established an endowment in memory of her husband Professor Donald J. Nelson, who was a faculty member in the Department specializing in teaching and research in a variety of areas of Biochemistry and Chemistry, to support summer research fellowships for undergraduate science students. On behalf of the Carlson School of Chemistry and Biochemistry faculty, I am pleased to inform you that you have been selected as a recipient of an award under this program and are appointed as a Donald J. Nelson Research Fellow for the summer of 2025.

The award will provide a potentially taxable stipend of \$4,000 for eight to ten weeks of full-time research (40 hours per week) under the direction of your faculty sponsor, Professor Arundhati Nag. A minimum of eight weeks is required, and the stipend will be pro-rated if you are unable to complete ten weeks of full-time research. Please coordinate with your faculty sponsor on the dates of your summer research.

To accept this award and receive the stipend, you will need to do the following in an email to the Department Chair, Luis Smith, ([lusmith@clarku.edu](mailto:lusmith@clarku.edu)):

1. Accept the fellowship and confirm that you have no other summer fellowships,
2. Commit to attending the required STEM Summer Workshops that Dr. Spratt will be hosting to help you prepare for your upcoming summer research project:
  1. **Wednesday, April 2<sup>nd</sup> 2-3:30pm** in Sackler S121  
"Discussions on the Importance of Soft Skills, Networking, and Resume Building"
  2. **Tuesday, April 15<sup>th</sup> 5:30-7pm** on in Sackler S121  
"Manuscript Planning, Upholding Scientific Integrity, and Having a Critical Eye When Reading the Scientific Literature"
3. Commit to presenting your work at the end of the summer, as well as at ClarkFEST in the following academic year.

As well, please be sure to credit the Donald J. Nelson Research Fund in future publications or presentations for this funding support.

Congratulations and best wishes for an enjoyable and productive summer.

Sincerely,

Luis Smith  
Associate Professor and Chair  
Carlson School of Chemistry and Biochemistry

cc. A. Nag